

Industry News

Indian smartphone users spend more time on Net than calls

Smartphone users in India spend more time on entertainment and Internet-based content than on voice calling and text messages, according to a report by Nielsen and Informatel Mobile Intelligence.



The study reveals that on an average, smartphone users spend 2.5 hours a day using their phones, with 72 per cent of their time spent on activities like gaming, entertainment, apps and Internet-related content. Out of these 2.5 hours, 28 per cent is spent on telephony and messaging.

MNC R&D centres growing in India

According to Zinnov Management Consulting's study titled *Operations Cost Benchmarking (OCB)*, the MNC R&D landscape in India is rapidly growing with a current base of over 700 MNCs having their R&D centres in India.

Financial year 2010-11 witnessed numerous changes in the operating cost dynamics for MNC R&D centres in India as their net cost increased by 9 per cent in terms of rupee and

Srinivasan takes over as AIA president

Automation Industry Association (AIA) has appointed Vijay Srinivasan as the new president. The association has also appointed K. Nandakumar, chairman and managing director, Chemtrols Industries, as vice president.

TVS Electronics appoints president and CEO

TVS Electronics has appointed Sastry Jonnavittula as the president and CEO, effective October 17, 2011. Jonnavittula has over 25 years of experience in the IT industry. He was with HP for the last 20 years, where he lastly held the position of director-technology support delivery.

Applied Materials appoints India president

Applied Materials, Inc. has appointed Aninda Moitra as the country president for India. Moitra will report to Manfred Kerschbaum, senior vice president, chief of staff, Applied Materials, Inc.

13 per cent in terms of dollar. This was after two years of declining input costs. The attrition rate for the industry hovered around 20 per cent in the last fiscal. MNC R&D centres in India also witnessed salary increments in the range of 10-15 per cent at an average.

Chandramouli C.S., director, Zinnov Management Consulting, said, "While most preferred Tier-1 R&D locations in India witnessed an increase in the operations cost, the R&D ecosystem around Tier-2 cities in the country benefited from the change. Tier-2 locations have started to mature and these locations are catching up fast by offering up to 40-50 per cent cost savings compared to Tier-1 cities."

In Focus

His responsibilities include overseeing alignment, coordination and execution of the company's business, operational and strategic activities in the country.

Chu appointed as Avnet's president, Asia Pacific, operations

William Chu has been appointed as the president, Avnet Technology Solutions, Asia Pacific, operations. Chu will be responsible for the strategic direction and profitable growth of Avnet's value-added IT solutions distribution business in the region, which encompasses Australia, New Zealand, China, Hong Kong, India and the ASEAN countries.

TE Connectivity appoints president

TE Connectivity, India has appointed V. Raja as the president. In his new role, Raja will continue to build the company's team and operations in India and serve as the company's executive leader with government officials and customers in India. He will report to Joe Donahue, TE's executive vice president and chief operating officer.

Cabinet okays cable network digitisation ordinance

The Cabinet Committee of Economic Affairs (CCEA) has cleared digitisation proposal for television services across all urban areas by 2014.

Fast-tracking the ongoing digitisation of TV broadcasts, cable operators will have to abandon the analogue platform in the four metros by March 31, 2012. Cities with a population of one million will be covered by March 31, 2013, all urban areas by September 30, 2014 and the entire country by December 31, 2014.

Presently, cable operators that use the analogue platform charge all customers a flat rate for a single package of less than 90 channels. The new ordinance to amend Section 4A of the